

An Examination of the Mediating Role of Eudaimonic Well-Being in the Relationship Between Psychological Flexibility and Subjective Well-Being

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Introduction

- **Life Satisfaction (LS):** Predicts future health and survival (Diener et al., 2018), thus, identifying antecedent causes of LS is important
- **Psychological Flexibility (PF):** Ability to behave consistently with personal values and goals even when challenging thoughts and emotions are occurring
- **Eudaimonic Well-Being (EWB; Ryff, 1989):** autonomy, environmental mastery, positive relations with others, self-acceptance, personal growth, purpose in life
- **PF Should Have An Indirect Effect On LS Via EWB**
 1. Experimental studies suggest PF leads to EWB (Fadafan et al., 2024; Naseri et al., 2024)
 2. Longitudinal studies suggest EWB leads to LS (Joshani, 2018, 2019)
 3. First 3 dimensions of EWB are similar to the 3 basic psychological needs for autonomy, competence, and relatedness whose satisfaction leads to LS (Martela & Sheldon, 2019) and also mediates the PF/LS relationship (Howell & Demuynck, 2023)

Purpose Of Study

- Examine whether PF has an indirect effect on LS via EWB and if so, examine which of the 6 dimensions of EWB are critical

Methods

Sample And Procedure

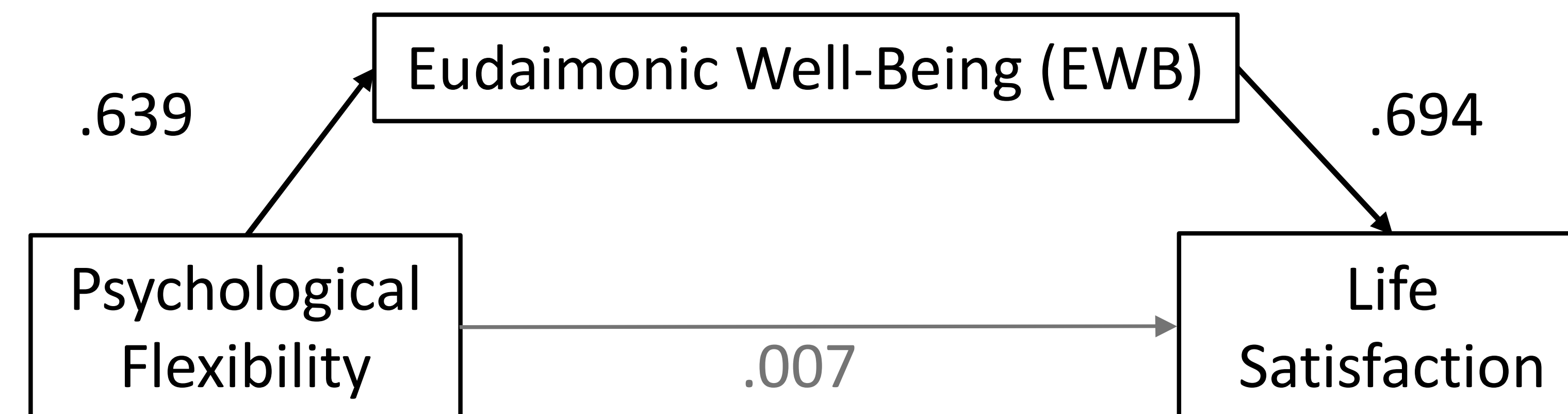
- 206 adults (18 to 40 years of age)
- Participants completed the following instruments
 - 5-item Satisfaction With Life Scale
 - 24-item Multidimensional Psychological Flexibility Inventory
 - 42-item Psychological Well-Being Scale (7 items per EWB dimension)

Analysis

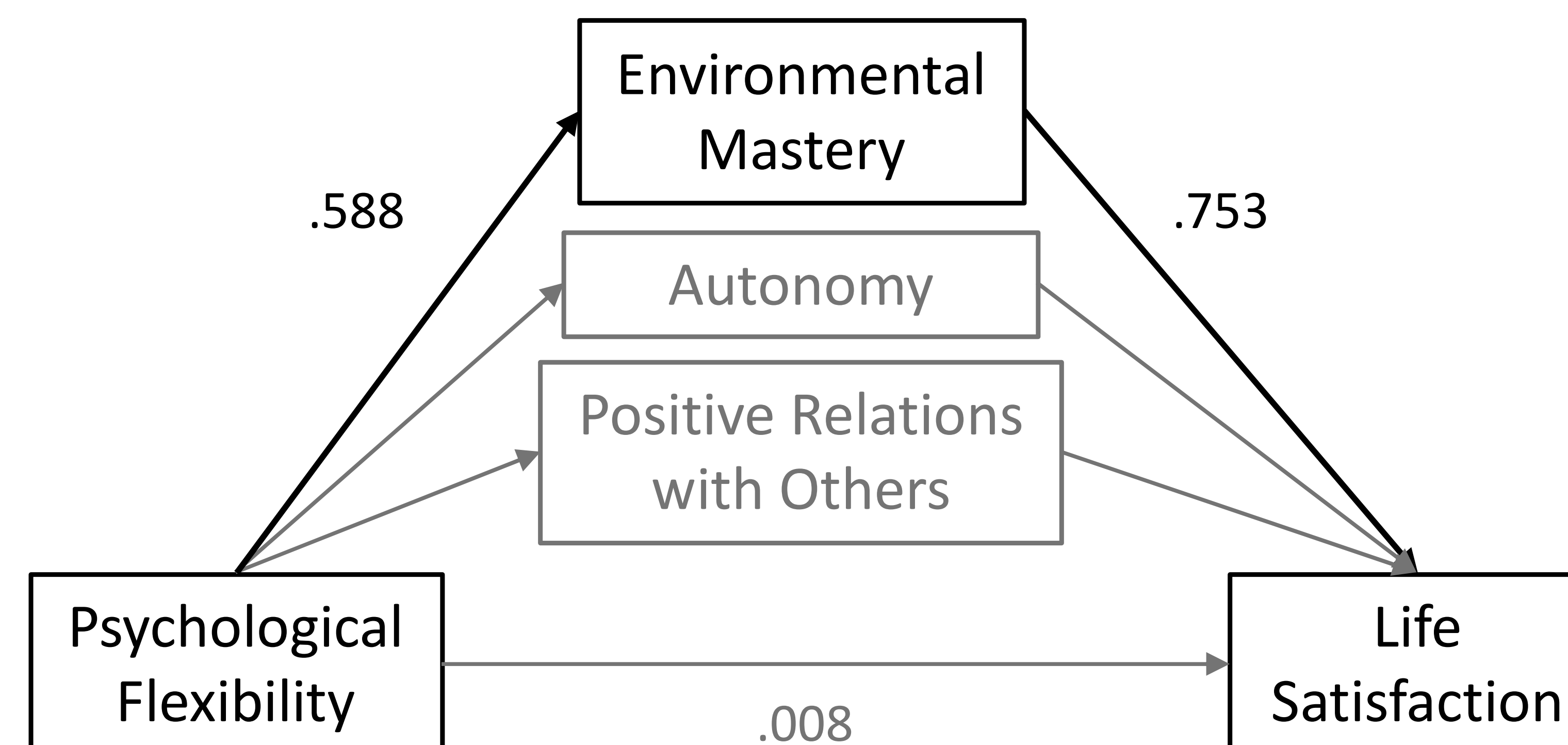
- Mediation models were analyzed using Hayes's Process macro
- Gender, age, income, education, relationship status were covariates
- Standardized coefficients are reported
- Indirect effects marked with ** are significant (i.e., the 95% confidence intervals exclude 0)

Results

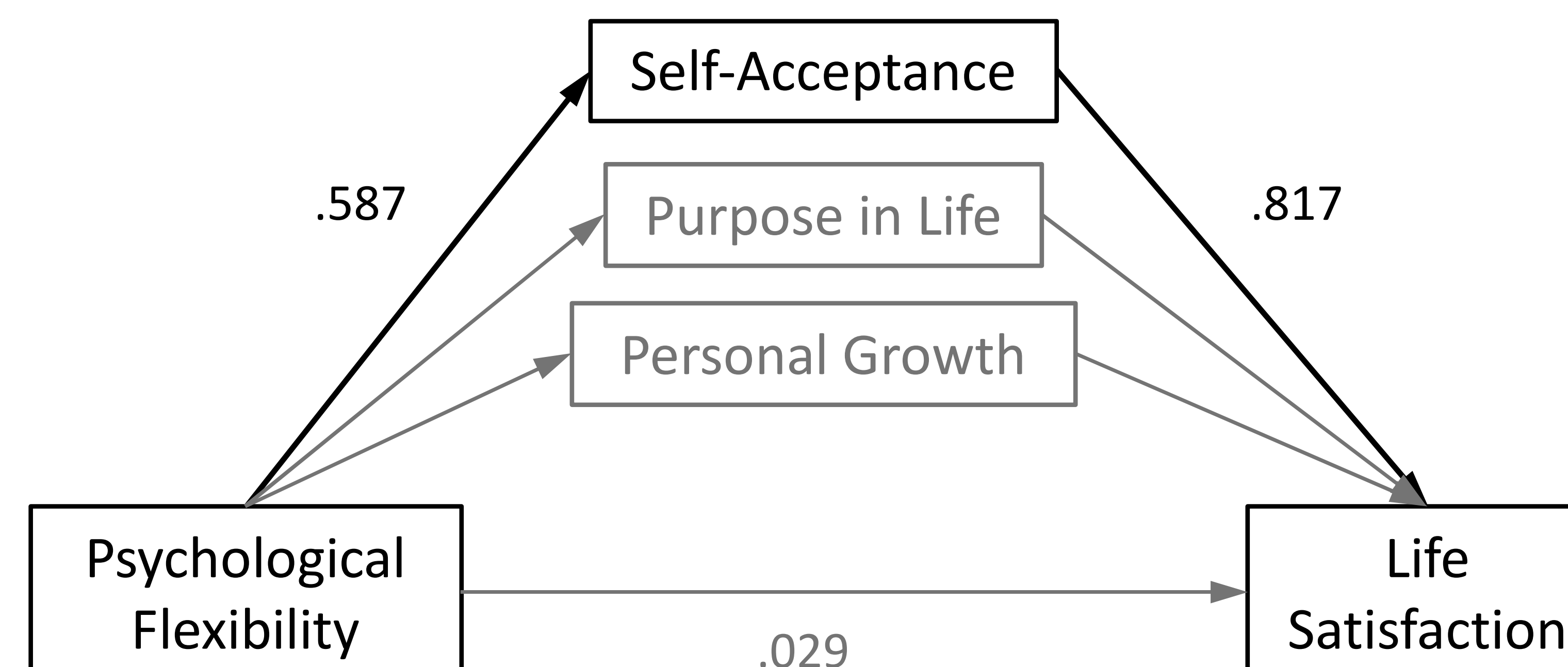
1. Indirect Effect Of Psychological Flexibility On Life Satisfaction Via Eudaimonic Well-Being (indirect effect = 0.443**)



2. Indirect Effect Of Psychological Flexibility On Life Satisfaction Via Env. Mastery (indirect effect = 0.443**) But Not Via Autonomy (indirect effect = -0.011) Or Positive Relations With Others (indirect effect = 0.009)

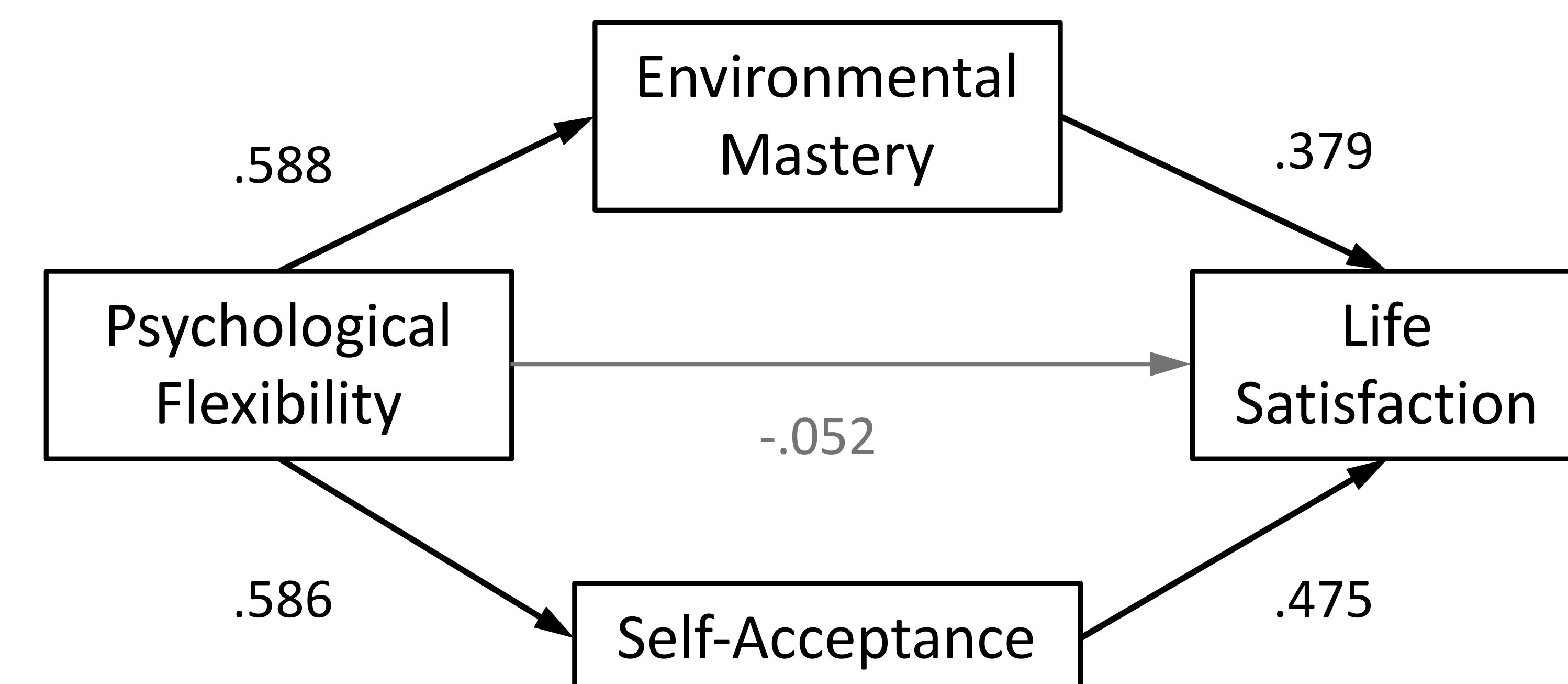


3. Indirect Effect Of Psychological Flexibility On Life Satisfaction Via Self-Acceptance (indirect effect = 0.479**) But Not Via Purpose In Life (indirect effect = -0.005) Or Personal Growth (indirect effect = -0.053)



Results

4. The Indirect Effects Of Psychological Flexibility On Life Satisfaction Via Environmental Mastery (indirect effect = 0.223**) and Self-Acceptance (indirect effect = 0.279**) Are Equally Potent



- Comparison of indirect effects: Difference = -0.056 (ns)

Discussion

- Psychological flexibility has equally potent indirect effects on LS via environmental mastery and self-acceptance
 - No evidence of indirect effects via other dimensions of EWB
 - No evidence of a direct effect of psychological flexibility on LS
- ### Why Environmental Mastery and Self-Acceptance?

- Individuals with greater psychological flexibility adapt to contextual demands, manage distress effectively, and align behaviors with their values (Hayes, 2020)
- Environmental mastery and self-acceptance have stronger associations with LS than other dimensions (Patrick et al., 2007; Ryff & Keyes, 1995).

Limitations And Future Directions

- All constructs were measured at one point in time (cross-sectional)
- Future studies could measure psychological flexibility, EWB, and LS at 2 or more points in time, or attempt to experimentally manipulate psychological flexibility or EWB and follow the effects over time